Forms and Uses of Present Continuous Tense

	First person	Second person	Third person
Affirmative			
***Singular**	I **am singing** now.	You **are singing** now.	She/He/It **is singing** now.
***Plural**	We **are singing** now.	You **are singing** now.	They **are singing** now.
Negative	I **am not singing** now.	You **aren't singing** now.	She/He/It **isn't singing** now.

Note: **The contracted form of 'am not' is aren't and the contracted form of are not is also aren't.**

Uses

- The Present Continuous Tense is used for an action that is in progress at the time of speaking.
- It is used for an action that is in progress and will continue in future.

e.g. Paul is learning English.

- It is used to denote an action that is planned to take place in the near future e.g. Yazhini is meeting the Prime Minister tomorrow.
- It is used along with adverbs such as 'always, constantly, repeatedly' etc. to express an action that has become a habit by doing it over and over again.

e.g. Sumithra is always asking questions.

Note: **Verbs of perception and some other verbs are not generally used in the present continuous tense, for example see, smell, hear, taste, know, understand, hate, like, want, wish, etc.**

Forms and Uses of Present Perfect Tense

	First person	Second person	Third person
Affirmative			
***Singular**	I **have** already **sung.**	You **have** already **sung.**	She/He/It **has** already **sung.**
***Plural**	We **have** already **sung.**	You **have** already **sung.**	They **have** already **sung.**
Negative	I **haven't** recently **sung.**	You **haven't** recently **sung.**	She/He/It **hasn't** recently **sung.**

- For an action which began in the past and is in progress now.

e.g. Bharani has called the fire man and they are on their way.

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